

| Incident Alert 0010. TLP CLEAR. |                                                                         | Date       | Breakout Scale |
|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|----------------|
| Title                           | FR - Unlabelled Political Ads from Burkina Faso Targeting French Voters | 11/06/2024 | 2              |

### Summary

- Between April 8 and May 24, 5 unlabelled political ads were run targeting French users with anti-Ukraine, anti-Macron, and New Caledonia-related messages by the Facebook page “Génération des patriotes”.
- One of the ads was taken down by Facebook for “This ad ran without a required disclaimer” while the others were left running.
- In total, the ads have managed to reach 61,708 users on Facebook and Instagram, paid for in USD.
- The two accounts administering the page are from Burkina Faso and are likely contractors.
- Flagged case to Meta and European Governments.

### Incident – When, Who did what, to say what, to whom, why?

Since October 2023, the page Génération des patriotes has published seven ads, two promoting the page itself ([1](#), [2](#)) on Facebook and five unlabelled political ads ([3](#), [4](#), [5](#), [6](#), [7](#)) on Facebook and Instagram.

Two ads are memes regarding the French intervention in New Caledonia. One ad features two demonstrators of African origin in France carrying signs claiming that “Macron is crazy” and “Stop the French mobilization” ([x](#)). Another two ads oppose a French intervention in Ukraine ([x](#), [x](#)).

The political ads were launched in relation to the European Parliamentary elections and civil unrest in New Caledonia. The page is operated by two administrators from Burkina Faso ([x](#)). The page likes two pages, one belonging to an entrepreneur in Social media consulting, based in Burkina Faso (Adama Sawadogo) ([x](#)). The two first ads promoting the page itself have been paid for by a profile named Moussa Compaoré. One of the profiles using the name ([x](#)) regularly amplifies the content of the page of Adama Sawadogo,

### Narrative

Meta narrative: Macron is acting against the interests of the people in regards to supporting Ukraine.  
Sub-narratives: France is going to send French Arabic and African minorities to fight in Ukraine.

### Impact

The page has around 1800 followers. The ads have managed to reach 61,708 users on Facebook and Instagram.

### Key Objectives and Behaviours (DISARM Red Framework)

- [Smear](#) - Trying to smear the French government's reputation ahead of the European Parliamentary Elections.
- [Create Inauthentic Social Media Pages and Groups](#) - The creation of a page posing as French patriotists while being operated from Burkina Faso.
- [Recruit Contractors](#) - It seems like a threat actor hired a contractor in Burkina Faso to run the page.
- [Deliver Ads](#) - the operation relied on delivering ads to attract audiences and deliver their operational content.
- [Manipulate Platform Algorithm](#) - The page is using obfuscation of text to avoid Meta’s content moderation.

### Recommendations

- Action taken: Page flagged to European governments and Meta 09/06/2024 – pending response.
- Meta’s Transparency Center for ads should also include a link to the profile or page that made the payment. Not just the name of the profile or page.

| Report               | Topic                               | Evidence | Authors                                                                                                 | Content type     | Platforms               |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|-------------------------|
| <a href="#">Link</a> | Elections, New California, Ukraine. | N/A      | <a href="#">Saman Nazari, A4E</a><br><a href="#">Rikard Friberg von Sydow</a> ,<br>Södertörn University | Meme, posts, Ads | FB Facebook, Instagram. |